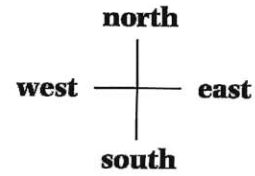
34 I can talk about my country



Brazil is **enormous**. The Atlantic **coast**[1] is more than 3,000 **kilometres long**, and **in the north**, **south**, and **west**, there are **borders**[2] with ten different countries. The longest **river**[3] is the Amazon, and Pico da Neblina is about 3,000 **metres high**: it's the **highest mountain**[4] in Brazil. The **capital**, Brasilia, is **inland**, but many of the **major** cities are **on the coast**. The most **famous** is Rio de Janeiro, which has Sugar Loaf mountain, Corcovado, and some great **beaches**. It is very **popular** with tourists.

Glossary

enormous very big
3,000 kilometres long 3,000 kms from one end to the other
3,000 metres high 3,000 m from top to bottom (A **mountain** is **high** NOT ~~tall~~.)
capital a city where a country has its government
inland not near the sea
major large and important
famous If something is **famous**, many people know about it. (Rio is **famous for** Carnival.)
beach area of sand next to the sea, e.g. Copacabana
popular If something is **popular**, many people like it.



1 **Study the map of Brazil for one minute, then complete the sentences.**

▶ The town in the north is Recife.
1 The town in the south is _____.
2 The capital is _____
3 The longest river is the _____
4 The highest mountain is _____
5 In the south, it has a border with _____
6 In the north, it has a border with _____
7 A popular city with tourists is _____
8 It's famous for Sugar Loaf _____.
9 Brasilia isn't near the sea; it's _____
10 Rio is on the _____

2 **Test yourself. Don't look at Exercise 1. What can you say about these places?**

▶ Recife — It's a town in the north of Brazil.

1 The Amazon
2 Pico da Neblina
3 Brasilia
4 Porto Alegre
5 Argentina
6 Rio de Janeiro

3 ABOUT YOUR COUNTRY **Write your answers or ask another student.**

1 What's the capital, and where is it? _____
2 What are some of the other major cities? _____
3 Does it have borders with any other countries? If so, what are they? _____
4 Which places are popular in summer? _____
5 What are the famous places in your capital city? _____